



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

PATIENT BALANCE & REVENUE-CYCLE RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Dental Practices

Recovering unpaid patient balances for a growing practice — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Emerald Dental Care** · August 2026

The balances that outlast the appointment

To Dr. Chaballout and the Emerald Dental Care team — you told us you have **\$10,000 to \$100,000** in outstanding receivables. For a practice your size that is real money, and it almost always sits in the same place: the patient-responsibility layer left after insurance pays. The crown that came back with a bigger deductible than expected, the implant or graft case a patient meant to finish paying, the family that moved across Pasco County and never updated a phone number. The dentistry was delivered. The claim was clean. The balance simply stayed.

Chasing those balances is the worst possible use of your front desk. The person asking a patient for money is the same person greeting them at their next cleaning — and every hour spent on a statement run is an hour not spent scheduling, verifying benefits, or answering the phone. Meanwhile the industry squeeze is real: costs have climbed faster than reimbursement for five straight years, which makes the dollars you have already earned matter more, not less.

Southwest Recovery Services has worked receivables on **pure contingency since 2004**, with recovery reach across all 50 states. We've collected millions of dollars in industries just like yours since 2004. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes an export from your practice management software, and we work them — compliantly, discreetly, and in a tone that keeps a patient willing to come back. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of receivables recovery — nationwide

A track record built on high-volume patient receivables and a documented, compliant process — a full collections function a single-location practice gets to use without hiring anyone.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

What a practice owner asks before handing over patient balances

Straight answers on cost, on how your patients are treated, on what actually gets recovered, and on how little this asks of your team.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. What does it cost?	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. For a practice your size that means there is no downside to placing: if we collect nothing, you owe nothing. We quote your rate once we've seen a representative sample of your aging.
2. How will my patients be treated?	Firm, respectful and discreet — never in a way that costs you the patient. No threats, no misrepresentation, no pressure tactics. FDCPA and Reg F requirements are enforced inside the workflow, consent and phone checks run before outreach, and every contact is documented. If a patient ever calls your office about it, you can see exactly what was said and when.
3. What should I actually expect back?	Honestly: it depends almost entirely on age. Balances placed within a few months of the last statement recover at a much higher rate than balances that have sat a year or more — not because the paper is different, but because people move and change numbers. We give you an age-based read on a real sample before you place anything, rather than a number designed to win the account.
4. What does this ask of my team?	Almost nothing, which is the point. Export your aging from your practice management software and upload it through our portal — we map your columns, so there is no re-keying and no new routine for your front desk. Work begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement. We also handle outsourced AR management and insurance follow-up if you'd rather have balances worked long before they reach placement.

Simple intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take an export from your practice management software and give a small front-office team live, self-service access throughout recovery.

PRACTICE-SOFTWARE-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an aging export from your practice management system — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send EOBs, itemized statements, treatment plans and financial-responsibility forms safely inside the portal — the documentation that resolves disputes fast.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports whenever you want them — a live dashboard instead of waiting on a monthly statement.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a patient makes at your front desk, so balances stay accurate and nobody is contacted about money they already paid.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Dental Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's dental book, anonymized by practice type and shown at the size a private practice actually places. The spread is real: the same work returns very different numbers depending mostly on how old the balances were when they arrived.

GENERAL DENTAL PRACTICE

Single-location practice

\$25K recovered

of ~\$61K placed

40% recovered

ORAL SURGERY PRACTICE

Patient balances after
benefits

\$26K recovered

of ~\$71K placed

37% recovered

PEDIATRIC DENTISTRY

Family patient book

\$19K recovered

of ~\$52K placed

37% recovered

FAMILY DENTAL PRACTICE

High-volume patient
book

\$61K recovered

of ~\$206K placed

30% recovered

ENDODONTIC SPECIALTY PRACTICE

Referral-based specialty
care

\$53K recovered

of ~\$225K placed

23% recovered

FAMILY DENTAL PRACTICE

Aged patient balances

\$54K recovered

of ~\$360K placed

15% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGE CURVE

Why the timing of placement matters more than anything else

A patient balance is most collectible while the treatment is recent and the contact information on file is still good. As it ages, patients move, numbers change, and the memory of the visit fades — which is why two practices with identical books can see completely different results based only on when they place.

WHAT WAITING COSTS

Balances placed within a few months routinely outperform the same accounts placed a year later by a wide margin — the dentistry doesn't change, the reachability does.

THE STANDING RULE

A simple “place at 90 days” habit recovers materially more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there is no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

We speak your ledger

A family practice offering everything from cleanings to implants and grafting carries a specific kind of receivable. Our approach is built for exactly that.



The balance after insurance pays

Deductibles, coinsurance, downgraded benefits and non-covered treatment — the remainder that survives a perfectly clean claim and then quietly ages.



Larger elective cases

Implants, veneers, grafting and full-mouth treatment plans carry balances big enough to hurt when they go unpaid, and they are worth pursuing properly rather than writing off.



Patients who have moved

Address and phone verification plus skip tracing for families who relocated within a fast-growing county — the single biggest reason aged patient balances go uncollected.



Your front desk stays a front desk

Recovery runs entirely outside your office, so the person who greets a patient at their next visit is never the person who asked them for money.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right approach reaches the right patient first, without anyone at your front desk picking through a list.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, voice and mailed notices, timed to when a patient is most likely to engage — replacing repeat statements and awkward front-desk calls with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account, and handled with the discretion a dental balance deserves.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation and recovery performance on your accounts in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement straight off your practice management software means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention on the balances most likely to be paid.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Emerald Dental Care

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Patient AR — The Cost of Waiting

Aged patient balances · PDF

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Medical Debt Compliance

FDCPA / Reg F / credit reporting · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's put a real number against your outstanding balances.

A 30-minute call to look at a representative sample of your patient balances — by age and by size — confirm how the export comes off your practice software, and put a contingency rate against it.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

Steven Dietz

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Emerald Dental Care. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.